First, there was the First World War from 1914 to 1918, which culminated with the Armistice in November 1918. The Amritsar report acknowledged that '[d]uring these years the confidence of the people in the established order of things had been shaken' so that '[t]hey were daily assailed with rumours pointing to the defeat of the British Arms, and no rumour was too wild to be believed'.[9] Second, there was the concern of 'the Musalman of India' for the plight of the Sultan, Mehmed VI of Turkey, who feared he would be deposed after the First World War, so that what the Government of India faced at home were the 'religious troubles' arising from the fact that '[f]or four years the British Empire has been fighting the Commander of the Faithful, and for the most loyal Musalman that is an uncomfortable and distressing position'. Moreover, 'this feeling was aggravated by the general belief that the British Government had instigated a puppet in the shape of the King of the Hedjaz to rise against the lawful authority of the Khalifa'.[10] There were therefore strong religious undercurrents which risked lighting the fuse of fire, which is why the report records that '[t]he penultimate stage of the agitation may be said to date from January 31st, when a meeting was held to protest about the future of Constantinople'.[11] Third, there was the economic hardship that the ordinary person was having to endure which raised the very real spectre of an insurrection. At the end of the Great War, 'the common people, and above all the lower middle class, were being hard hit by the rise in prices' and 'a large part of the urban population was suffering want and there is nothing which better prepares the ground for revolution'.[12] In fact, it was not just the ordinary person because '[t]he commercial classes were irritated by taxation which they were not used to . . .'.[13] Fourth, it was said that '[t]o all this must be added the reaction after the armistice' and what was meant by this was that '[s]o long as the War went on, people could and did accept their discomforts as a natural consequence, and hope for the end. But when the end came and the victory had been celebrated nothing seemed to happen'. So now, '[p]rices and taxes were as high as ever, and it is no wonder that discontent grew into an angry bewilderment as to whether after all the